VOLUME-2

EPISODE-4

BLACKOUT

Come on, Guardians. Show me what you're capable of.

TARGET ANALYSIS : ALPHA
SPEED : EXTREME
STRENGTH : EXTREME
FLIGHT PATTERN : ANALYSED
ATTACK PREDICTION : ACTIVE
COUNTER STRATEGY : READY

I've already seen what you can do.

KRAANG!

Slow again.

Every time I move, he knows where I'm going.

Then stop giving him the movements he's expecting.

Don't attack one after another.

Six directions. All at once.

TARGET ANALYSIS : EXTINCT
TRAJECTORY : DIRECT IMPACT
PREDICTION : 98.7%
ADJUSTING COUNTER...

Ahh—?

Got something!

MULTIPLE THREATS DETECTED
PREDICTION ACCURACY : 62.3%
ATTACK VECTORS : 4
REAL-TIME ADJUSTMENT : ACTIVE

Let's see your machine calculate that!

FSSSHHH!

Wrong move.

UNKNOWN ENERGY SIGNATURE
ATTACK NOT REGISTERED
PREDICTIVE RESPONSE FAILED
SYSTEM STABILITY : CRITICAL
ADAPTATION : IN PROGRESS

ARMOUR INTEGRITY : 63%
FLIGHT CONTROL : ERRATIC
TARGET ANALYSIS : INCOMPLETE
COUNTER : NOT FOUND

That wasn't in your combat profile!

You missed something then.

TARGET MODEL INVALID
VRAAAAM!
Let's see you dodge without those!
CLANG! CLANG!
You can predict my moves all day!
You can't predict what I haven't decided yet!
MOVEMENT MODEL UNSTABLE
You think a few unexpected moves will defeat me?
I built this armour to adapt!
MULTIPLE INPUT CONFLICT
TARGET PREDICTION FAILURE
COMBAT CONTROL UNSTABLE
No... stabilise!
TARGET ACQUISITION FAILED
DOOOOM!
Not going anywhere this time!
You could have chosen another way.
KRAAANG!
KRRAASH!
Get off me!
You should have stopped when you had the chance.
The helmet's still holding.
Let's change that.
FSSSSSSS!
Stop! What are you doing?!
Taking away your mask.
K-CHUNK!
KROOS BUNKER
Kroos?
What the fuck, man?
You're a doctor!
A doctor created this armour?

He's a doctor?

You treated people. You saved lives. And then you built this thing to attack us?

Why not me?

Why shouldn't a doctor build something like this?

You Guardians and your enemies have been destroying everything in this city!

Buildings, homes, hospitals!

You fight each other, tear the place apart, and then stand in front of cameras pretending you're saving everyone!

You call yourselves protectors. But who protects the people who lose everything when you fight?

Who gives them their lives back?

So you decided to hurt people to make your point? You attacked my team. You destroyed a street. You nearly killed Hazard!

And how many people have you nearly killed?

THWACK!

You are the one created me Alpha?

She had been fighting cancer for almost two years.

1 YEAR 1

YEAR 2

Two years of treatment. Two years of pain. Two years of believing that one day she would finally go home.

Finally, she recovered.

The day she left the hospital, I thought she is going to live her best from now on.

KRRRRAAAAAK!

NO! NO, NO, NO!

Please... please wake up...

HOSPI

You were right there...

And my patient was dead.

Two years of struggle.

Gone within seconds.

You will repent.

Do you know what I did after that day?

I went back to the hospital.

She had a dream.

All the mornings she want to see children play rather lye on bed that's her dream.

I saved her once.

Why couldn't I save her that day? Is she did something wrong why she should die?

I couldn't bring her back.

But I could make sure the people responsible would never escape the consequences again.

I studied every fight. Every movement. Every failure.

If their strength made them untouchable, I would build something that could stand against them.

That armour wasn't built to make me a hero.

It was built because I was tired of watching people like you walk away.

When I graduated I pledged to save everyone who needs help.

I don't need a white coat for that.

I knew people had died that day...

But I never knew her.

You don't care about that one girl.

Because she is not yours.

Don't move.

Why?
Afraid I'll hurt another person like you?

Hahaha...

Your grief is real.
Your anger is understandable.

But that does not excuse what you chose to do today.

And what about what you chose to do?

You attacked us. You nearly killed Hazard.
You endangered everyone in this street.

And you think putting me in a cell will fix anything?

Will it rebuild their homes?
Will it bring that girl back?

Alpha...?

...

You're coming with us.

Of course I am.

You always take people away when they become inconvenient.

Do you actually think you're heroes?

No!

You have no idea what you really are!

You're nothing but test-tube experiments!

You made people ugly!
You made people inject themselves with things they never understood!

And now you stand there pretending you're the ones saving them!

Look at yourselves!

You don't even know where you came from!

CLANG!

What's the age of that girl?

...

Nine.

Test-tube experiments...
—Kroos (Echo)

You made people inject themselves..."
—Kroos (Echo)

GUARDIANS

MGen83'

CONFIDENTIAL

SUBJECT REPORT

A subject whose results were described as unusually stable.

Genetic alteration.
Enhanced recovery.
Controlled mutation response.

[redacted]

MGen83'

GENETIC ALTERATION

The laboratory...

How could Kroos know about that?

Was he talking about the same thing we found?

Alpha? What's wrong?

Those things Kroos said...

About test tubes. About people injecting themselves with something.

I don't think he was just talking about the armour.

There's something I need to check.

What is it?

I need a favour.

Air King

Air King

I repeated many times don't put your clothes in my machine!

Emma I am talking to you .. What are you seeing..

LIVE
NEPAL FLOOD CRISIS
MASSIVE FLOODS DISPLACE THOUSANDS

A flood? No way we need to get out of here quick!

Get out of here? What about others?

Others? Emma it's a flood what we can do just pack your bags let's leave.

Katherine why are you being so selfish and not knowing what's happening around you.

Do you want coffee?

What?

Do you want coffee?

Mam do you need coffee?

No... I am fine.

I understand what you went through, Kroos. But think about it... is this really the way you can repay it?

You didn't see what I saw.

Maybe not. But we know what it feels like to lose people.

We're not the ones you should be directing your anger at.

Mutants from darkcity are the real problem.

I don't classify you people as different individuals.

Mutants are mutants. Wherever they go, they bring destruction.

I'm not a mutant.

I'm a human being, just like you.

But haven't I been fighting against them too?

Listen, Kroos. You have a great profession, a great background, and a great family—

No!

What do you mean, no?

I don't have a family.

...

I spent my entire life in medicine.

Every day was about patients. Research. Saving lives. Finding answers to problems nobody else could solve.

I kept telling myself there would be time for everything else later.

I never made that time.

I don't have anyone waiting for me at home.

I'm just... alone.

Then maybe you're a better listener than you think.

And maybe there's still a place for someone like you on a team that helps people.

If you genuinely accept what you've done was wrong, and you're willing to make up for it, we'll talk to the authorities about your release.

But that decision is yours to make.

These people...

They're the ones I attacked.

Listen, mate. None of us chose to be here doing this job.

But you chose medicine. You chose to save lives.

Saving lives is bigger than anything else you could do with your abilities.

...

GUARDIANS SYNDICATE HEADQUARTERS UNDERGROUND DETENTION CENTER

B1
B2
B3
B4
B5

A private detention center. For those the Syndicate can no longer trust.

Alpha Void, sir.

Sir, excuse me. Where are you going?

To see Adam Taylor.

I'm sorry, sir. Visiting Taylor is restricted.

What?

You need to leave, sir.

Please understand. Mr Taylor is a restricted detainee. Nobody enters without clearance from the director.

I'm not asking you to release him.

I'm asking you to let me speak to him.

I'm sorry, sir. I have my orders.

And I have questions.

I still can't let you in.

Don't make this more difficult than it needs to be.

Sir... please.

Move.

Control, this is the detention corridor.

Alpha Void is entering the restricted cells without authorisation.

Yes, sir. I'm informing the director immediately.

Katherine? You're back already?

Not Katherine.

Alpha?

I don't care what they see, Taylor. Tell me everything you know.

You heard me.

You shouldn't be here.

I've heard that enough times today.

I'll help you out of this, Taylor. Whatever evidence they have against you, whatever they've done to keep you quiet— we'll deal with it.

But first, tell me everything you know about the Syndicate.

You can't do anything, Alpha.

Try me.

They're more powerful than you think. You can't just overpower them and expect everything to end.

I've spent my entire life fighting things I didn't understand.

I'm done letting other people decide what I'm allowed to know.

Alpha, don't—

VZZZRAAAAM!

Do you have any idea what they'll do when they find out?

I don't care about them anymore.

Tell me, Taylor. What do you know?

The Syndicate wasn't a serving organisation.

It is a power that controls everyone.

The country. The continent.

The decisions governments make.

Eventually, the world itself.

Imagine possessing weapons nobody else can defend against.

Imagine having soldiers no ordinary army can defeat.

Who would stand against you?

Everyone would be forced to obey.

That was the dream.

They called it **SUPERPOWER.**

It began in 1852, as a military experiment.

1852

They wanted to create **super-soldiers**—men who could survive what ordinary soldiers couldn't.

They experimented on wounded soldiers, prisoners of circumstance, and refugees who had nowhere else to go.

They tried different methods. Different compounds. Different ways of changing the human body.

PROJECT SUBJECT COMPOUND A7

Most of the attempts failed.

Hundreds suffered.
Hundreds died.
The programme continued anyway.

Hundreds?

They believed the result would justify the cost.

1883

Then came 1883.

Something happened that year.

I never found a complete account of what it was. The records didn't call it a success. They didn't call it a failure either.

They called it an **OUTCOME**.

RESEARCH ARCHIVE

OUTCOME — FURTHER INVESTIGATION REQUIRED.

After that, the research continued. Genetic engineering. Chemical modification. New formulas and new variants.

They weren't looking for one miracle anymore. They were looking for a process they could repeat.

Eventually, one compound Became stable enough to produce a repeatable genetic response.

MGen83'.

They developed different formulations and variants. They adjusted the compound until they could influence human genetics more consistently.

And then they used it on you.

Your case was considered a success.

After that, the research expanded. The compound was modified for different subjects and different outcomes.

Some people volunteered. **Others** never had a choice.

Wait.

The mutants... are you saying they're all connected to this?

Many of them are.

Some parents wanted their children to be different. Stronger. More capable. They believed a mutant child would have advantages in a world that rewards power.

In the beginning, attempts to alter a child's genetics during pregnancy often ended in tragedy. Some mothers died. Some pregnancies failed.

The research continued until the process became more stable.

So people knew?

And they still agreed to it?

Some did. Some knew only what the Syndicate wanted them to know.

They wanted their children to be special. They wanted them to have a better chance than ordinary people.

What consequences?

But the consequences became bigger than anyone expected.

Repeated genetic modifications began influencing the population itself. Mutant traits became heritable and increasingly common.

The Syndicate changed the course of human genetics. Now, according to the reports I saw, almost one in three babies born in this country exhibits mutant traits.

One in three?

The process was no longer limited to individual experiments. It had changed the population.

Dark City has the highest concentration in the area, mutant traits. And now **Ashton is changing too.**

THUD!
THUD!
THUD!

I'm sorry, Alpha.

You're going to lose against them.

I will never.

Alpha Void! Step away from the prisoner!

I'm having a conversation.

You're inside a restricted detention area without authorisation. You need to come with us.

Then you'll have to wait.

Alpha, listen to me. Don't make this worse.

You just told me the entire country is being changed by an organisation hiding behind a public image.

I'm done making things easy for them.

Director Klover.

Hello, sir. I'm Richard Klover. I'm currently one of the directors of the Syndicate.

Hmm. It seems Mr Taylor has told you a few things.

That's alright. We can leave that for now.

Can we talk?

Aren't you ashamed?

Ashamed of what? What exactly have I done wrong?

Listen, Alpha. This is how the system works. This is how we work.

And this is how you should work.

You've spent your life protecting the world we built. Why start questioning it now?

Sir!

I don't work for this organisation anymore.

And I'm going to tell the people everything.

You can't do anything, Alpha.

I can clear you all out of this building in seconds.

And if that's what it takes to expose you, I'll do it.

We are the ones who created you.

So we know how to control you.

What's that supposed to be?

Insurance.

When we created you, we knew you were the most powerful result we'd ever seen.

But we also knew that one day, you might turn against us.

So we prepared for that possibility.

A control chip. Hidden inside you.

You couldn't risk our greatest creation becoming our greatest mistake.

Is this some kind of joke? —

CLICK.

I hate jokes.

AAAGH!

Director?

Stay where you are.

Fuuuuuucckkkk...

Is it good?

Now do you understand?

You may be powerful, Alpha. But power doesn't mean freedom.

We know everything you do.

What you see, we see. What you hear, we hear.

Who you meet. Who you speak to. Where you go.

Every conversation. Every investigation. Every little secret you thought belonged to you.

And you've been spending time with someone rather interesting, haven't you?

LIVE FEED
ASHTONDAILY OFFICE

CAM 07
FLOOR 12
ASHTONDAILY
14:28:06

PRESS

Amy Adams. A reporter in AshtonDaily.

LIVE FEED
ASHTONDAILY OFFICE

She's been doing some digging of her own.

How coincidental.

Leave her out of this.

Leave her out of what?

I'm simply showing you how much we know.

LIVE FEED
TRIBHUVAN INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT
KATHMANDU, NEPAL

And isn't this interesting?

Didn't she tell us she was going to visit her native place?

What a coincidence that she's there now.

AMY ADAMS
ASHTONDAILY OFFICE

QUEEN
KATHMANDU AIRPORT

It's not just Amy.
It's not just Queen.

Everyone you communicate with.
Everyone you trust.

You were our eyes and ears, Alpha.

You were out there, living your life, meeting people, discovering things.

And all the while, we were watching.

All this time...

You watched me?

All these years?

You course.

Why would we create something like you and then stop paying attention?

I'lldestroy every last piece of this organisation.

You keep saying that.

And you keep forgetting who made you.

CLICK.

AAAGHHH!

You can fly faster than any aircraft.

You can destroy buildings with your bare hands.

You can look at a person and see through walls.

But you can't even stand when I tell you not to.

Look at me.

I said, look at me.

I know you'll remember everything that happened here.

You're stronger than most people. Your mind will hold on to this.

Don't worry.

We'll take care of those memories, too.

What?

CLICK.

AAAAAGHHH!

AAAAAGHHH!

You should have stayed a hero, Alpha.

AMY ADAMS
ASHTONDAILY OFFICE

QUEEN
KATHMANDU AIRPORT

Clear every CCTV footage. Erase the record of his visit.

I don't want this conversation in any report. No footage, no entry record, nothing.

Understood, sir.

And make sure nobody asks questions.

REC 00:12:46

Alpha...

What did they do to him?

"We'll take care of those memories, too."

EARLIER THAT DAY
AFTER THE DARK VIGILANTE FIGHT

I need a favour.

What kind of favour?

You mean something like these?

Something small enough to hide, difficult enough to find, and something nobody would think to look for?

You always understand things faster than I explain them.

That's because you explain things terribly.

I'll make something.

You know what I need?

I think I do.

If anyone had been listening, they would have heard nothing suspicious.

No one would see it. No one would know it was there.

But for what?

He knew something was wrong...

The recording stops.

What if they answer?

Alpha

Locked

What am I supposed to do now?
I can't even share this with any Guardians.
I don't know who hears from where.

I can't fight the entire Syndicate by myself.

Are they watching me too?

THUMP!

AH—!

It's just a cat.

Get a grip, Daru.
Get a grip.

Daru? You're home early.

What happened? Is everything alright?

Daru, what are you doing?

Daru!
Answer us!

No hidden devices.
No recording equipment.
Nothing.

At least here...

Sweetheart, you're frightening us. What happened?

If they can do that to him...

What if this started long before I ever joined the Guardians?

Daru, what happened today?

You came home terrified. Did someone threaten you?

"Some parents wanted their children to be different. Stronger. More capable. They believed a mutant child would have advantages in a world that rewards power."

Dad. Mom. Do you know about that mutant chemical?

What chemical, Daru? What are you talking about?

Mom?

MGen83'.

Or maybe it had a different name. A different variant.

Do you know anything about it?

Mom...

What is this nonsense? Daru, you've clearly had a frightening day.

Go make her a coffee. She needs to calm down.

Daru!

What are you doing?!

aru!

WHUMM!

I asked you a question!

Do you know about **MGen83**'?

Listen to me. You're frightened, and you're not thinking clearly.

Then tell me I'm wrong. Tell me you have never heard that name.

If you say no, then prove it.

When your mother was pregnant with you, the doctors told us there were possibilities...

We were told that certain treatments could give our child unusual abilities.

We were ambitious. We wanted you to have every advantage.

We thought we were making the right decision.

Your mother had difficulties during the pregnancy. We were afraid. But we believed the treatment would work.

We were told the risks had been reduced. We thought...

You thought what?

So you injected yourselves with that chemical because you wanted a mutant child?

You wanted a child who would make you rich. Someone who would help you achieve everything you wanted!

No! No, Daru, that's not the truth. We tried to—

We never thought of you that way!

You're special, Daru.

You can do amazing things.

We're so proud of you.

When I first started using my powers, you encouraged me like you knew nothing about it.

I thought you were proud of me because I was your daughter.

But you planned everything. You treated me like an investment.

I had so much respect for you both.

I thought you wanted me to become a good person in this world.

But you injected your own baby just to feed your pride.

Daru, we loved you! We still love you! Then why didn't you tell me the truth?

We were wrong. We were so wrong.

We were afraid of what would happen if we refused. We were also afraid of losing the opportunity. We convinced ourselves we were doing it for your future.

You decided my future before I could even be born.

Everything was a lie, wasn't it?

Was any of it real?

.....

Daru, wait!

Please, sweetheart. Don't leave like this!

Please listen to us! We made a mistake, but we never wanted to hurt you!

I need to get out of here and never coming back.

Whatever you spent on that chemical...

I'll pay you back.

That's not what we wanted!

Then you should never have made me feel like I owed you my life.

CHAOS SYNDICATE — DARK CITY. NIGHT.

Total surveillance of Ashton is in the hands of the Chaos Syndicate.

SHOPPING DISTRICT

ROOFTOP 12

CITY INTERSECTION

GUARDIANS SYNDICATE HQ

Come on, Alpha.

GUARDIANS SYNDICATE HQ
CAM 01
22:14:37

TARGET:
ALPHA VOID

GUARDIANS SYNDICATE HQ
CAM 01
23:26:17

Where are you?

Proto.

Yes, Master!
I was just examining something fascinating.
If we modify the—

.....

—and then, theoretically, if the output exceeds—

You went inside.

GUARDIANS SYNDICATE HQ
CAM 01
22:14:37

TARGET:
ALPHA VOID

So why haven't you come back out?

HMMMM...

Alpha?

Show me.

Come on...

What is this?

Something is wrong with Alpha.

Proto!

Yes, Master?

Send troops to Ashton. Now.

What?

Master, is this necessary?

If something bad is happening to him, it will help us win this war, Master.

LIVE

GUARDIANS SYNDICATE HQ

VMMMM...

Alpha was never our enemy, Proto.

Our ideologies are different. That's all.

We need him on our side.

Otherwise, we will never win this war.

There is only Alpha...

...or nothing.

TARGET: ALPHA VOID

Master...?

Soldiers.

CLANK. CLANK. CLANK.

Get ready...

...for a destruction.

KRRRZZZT...

!

He came.

Greetings, mate.

TO BE CONTINUED...